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**r/GooglePixel** • 1y ago
srj737

Decade of Maps Timeline data lost from backup on ~ 7th March 2025. Anyone else effected?

UPDATE 22/Mar:

Huzzah! Two weeks after the 'incident', Google sent out an email admitting to it for the first time, but all it said was essentially 'try to import backup, but if that doesn't work you're out of luck'. This is something I have ALREADY tried many times - almost every day since - and importing the backup only brought data back from post-7th March... Making me think the previous decade of data was well and truly lost...

But I tried the same steps again this morning, and thankfully, it WORKED! So obviously some sort of fix has been published (possibly just to Google's own backup-containing servers) and the inaccessible data is now available again. ***I'm not sure how many people this will help (because there were lots of subtly different issues occurring), but I encourage everyone to try AGAIN to IMPORT any backup!***

And if that works then 100% make sure that you *regularly* export 'un-encrypted' backups, just so you have control over your own data in case something like this happens again! (i.e. by doing: Phone's Settings > Location > Location Services > Timeline > Export timeline data)

Initial Post

Very upset right now, as over a decade of Timeline data has been lost!

- Last year (approx. Aug 2024), I followed all of the steps that had been emailed out to complete the conversation to local encrypted storage for timeline data.
- My main phone is a Google Pixel 8, running Android 15 and generally the latest updates of all apps.
- My Timeline settings were definitely set to "**Backup: On; Auto-Delete: Never**" last year, and backups would have been successfully uploading to the cloud backup for months.
- Then suddenly on 09/Mar/2025, I noticed that my timeline data was mostly empty - losing over a decade of data.
- When attempting to "Restore" from the cloud backup (*which is dated "2 days ago" as of now, so either 07/Mar/2025 or 08/Mar/2025*), - from any device including totally fresh ones - and **NO** data is returned from before ~6pm GMT on Friday 07/Mar/2025.
- This is despite the fact that I **KNOW** for certain that the decade of data **used** to be included in that backup before. (Because I changed phones late last year in November and everything was transferred over then).
- After reading lots of other people's forum posts complaining about the same problem, it now doesn't seem related to specific phones / versions, as I've seen it happened to people with Samsungs and different Pixels, using anywhere from Android 12 to 15... (*It definitely just feels like someone at Google accidentally deployed the wrong thing or deleted something from production!*)
- Some users report that their high level 'Places', 'Vists' and 'Countries' etc, still show the old totals. Unfortunatly mine have been reduced to patechic post-March 7th figures.

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*Also, note: because there is a sea of Timeline support questions/articles/reddit posts/etc. that are relating to the migration to local storage last year - this is NOT the problem here. I successfully migrated, and that was successful. **Instead this is a sudden loss of previously backed-up data occurred in early March 2025.***

Summary

It appears to me that, something out of our control (*possibly due to a bug in Google Maps app or purely on Google's servers*) caused the Timeline data to be **NOT ONLY** deleted all pre-March 7th from **OWN LOCAL DEVICES (!!!)**, but **ALSO** has **caused previously-successful "Cloud Backups" to over OVERWRITTEN with a backup containing no data from before March 7th...**

I know this is the case for me because:

1. Doing an import of the current cloud backup to a different new device contains no data from before March 7th.
2. And I know for a **certainty** that that **SAME** cloud backup **USED TO** contain a decade of timeline data, because in November last year I did a factory reset of my device and all the data was loaded successfully after importing.

I worry that, regardless of whether or not any potential bug is "fixed" in the Maps application going forward - for me and many others it might not make a blind bit of difference - as the data in the backup on Google's servers has gone, and could only possibly be restored by Google themselves in the back-end (*e.g. Internally restore a March 6th backup and enable users like me to be able to "import" that data backup*).

And as far as I know, it has been **complete radio silence** from Google employees about this....

On the Google Maps help community forums, the user 'Vishal Saini' has been replying to anyone and everyone who posts about this, saying that "*a bug may have caused this*" and half-impling that a Google development team "*may*" be looking into it (*but I understand that he is not a Google employee and I have no reason to believe he has anymore information than we do...*). This is **not at all** reassuring because, as explained, I think this issue is going to require manual intervention by Google employees to re-consolidate/make available each users' last successful backup pre-March 7th...

As this is an issue **affecting at least dozens of users** who have cared enough to post online about it (*see below for a list*) - meaning that once you include all those who don't bother to post/haven't noticed yet/don't care - it's really likely an issue that is **affecting 100s if not 1000s of users...** (**EDIT: Because within a couple of days, I have found many reddit posts; >50 community forum posts all posted in a single day, often with a couple of others sounding "me too" in the comments; and over 620 people marking "I have the same question" to this one in 7 days so far(!!!) I'd revise my estimate that the true numbers affected are much more likely to be in 10,000s of total users at the very least...**)**

Surely, with such a widespread outage, Google would be able to restore those previously-successful, now-deleted, cloud backups that they were were storing successfully up until at least 06th March 2025?!

Or is this just unfortunately another lesson that mega corporations like this, can treat users like s**t, by not even acknowledging anything happened, and it doesn't make a damn difference...

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Vishal Saini: "We have been receiving such reports since March 6/7, 2025, it may be a transient issue, so you should wait for a few days. Alternatively, to check data availability, please try importing your data, if the backup option was enabled, this is a new option, for that you need to tap on the Cloud button - three dots - Import, if it doesn't work then try importing to a spare phone, if you have a spare phone, if none of the solutions work then you should wait for a few days, if it's a transient issue, otherwise, the timeline data deleted by the system cannot be recovered."

~~That gives a very slight slither of hope that it is a reasonably widespread problem that they are working on resolving and may fix itself in time... But if not, it's pretty shitty behaviour that they have deleted many users data that they explicitly stated was securely "backed up"...~~

EDIT: As explained above, I don't think this person works for Google, nor have I seen no evidence that he know anymore than we do - he directly ignored my question about this when asked - so I don't think listening to his speculation is any help....

The **FIRST** thing I recommend anyone who experiences this tries to do, is to attempt to do a manual backup of the unencrypted data. You can do this via:

Phone's Settings > Location > Location Services > Timeline > Export timeline data

If this returns a small file, move to the steps below, but if returns a relatively large 'json' file (e.g. >1MB), then you likely have all the data contained in that file. It doesn't necessarily ever make it viewable in the Google Maps app, but at least you'd still have the data yourself... And you could then view it in another tool, such as: <https://timelineviewer.pages.dev/> - (NB: I'm not verifying the safety of this particular viewer - but it's just an example of multiple that you find when googling, including self-hosted ones). Unfortunately, for me this is only post-March 7th data.

The following steps have apparently worked for people to recover, but unfortunately none have worked for me:

1. Go into Timeline, and turn it off and then on again.
2. Import from the timeline backups.
3. Log in to Google Maps app from a totally fresh device.
4. Deleting the Maps app cache (but importantly NOT the data!)
5. This user saying logging in with another account worked for whatever reason, https://www.reddit.com/r/GoogleMaps/comments/1j7xv0r/google_maps_timeline_data_wiped_recovered_lost/, but again it didn't work for me...

Currently the data looks to be well and truly lost... Unfortunately, I don't think GDPR has a 'Right to be remembered'!

Tracking other Articles/Posts

Articles:

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more on Google (maybe more users in comments). <https://support.google.com/maps-timeline-missing/>

Reddit Posts:

- https://www.reddit.com/r/google/comments/1j78uau/timeline_disappeared/
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1j5iigv/timeline_history_completely_gone/ (Possibly the exact same issue, but if not, then at least similar)
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GoogleMaps/comments/1j5joqo/another_timeline_issue_please_help/
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GoogleMaps/comments/1jb21ef/my_google_maps_timeline_deleted_out_of_no_where/
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GoogleMaps/comments/1jazip1/google_maps_timeline_history_disappeared_before/
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GoogleMaps/comments/1j7weli/google_maps_timeline_disappeared_after_oppor/
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GoogleMaps/comments/1jaxq3h/google_timeline_disappeared/
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GoogleMaps/comments/1jandus/my_timeline_has_been_deleted/
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GoogleMaps/comments/1j6revb/how_i_recovery_20_years_of_history_location/
- https://www.reddit.com/r/GoogleMaps/comments/1jb1ski/the_lack_of_communication_regarding_the_timeline/
- {{and many more incoming all the time...}}

And the motherlode - other Google Community forum posts:

1. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/329356095> **NOTE: This is the biggest and most extensive thread that I've seen by far!** 620 people have marked it as "*I have the same question*" with ~80 comments, but no solution or even any actual response from Google... (There's no evidence that Vishal Saini, who replies to everyone, has any insider information or even communication with any employee of Google).
2. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330028155>
3. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330047175>
4. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330060060>
5. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330057455>
6. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/329627609> (The user Vishal Saini first responded here 8th March with a response that implied may have been due to user error around the transfer to local storage or auto-delete. But as more complaints have come in, they now (10th March) respond with the response I've posted above)
7. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330045686>
8. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330044132>
9. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330064466>
10. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330064430>
11. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330067433>
12. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330061533>
13. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330070892>
14. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330160559>
15. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330159137>

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10. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/329940233>
19. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330130687>
20. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330121385>
21. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330119077>
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29. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330101981>
30. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330096004>
31. <https://support.google.com/maps/thread/330094344>
32. ...

There are loads more, but I can't be bothered tracking anymore...



Archived post. New comments cannot be posted and votes cannot be cast.

174

235

[Share](#)Sort by: **Best** ▾[🔍 Search Comments](#)**saharaci** • 1y ago

Oh no that's awful!! Just checked mine and it's ok - as a precaution I just took a manual backup.

Instructions for those interested in the manual backup:

Settings > Location > Location Services > Timeline > Export timeline data

**srj737** **OP** • 1y ago

Yep, I recommend everyone who still can does the same!

**Lalfy** • 1y ago

Export timeline data

I don't see this option? Infact it's all blank. [This is what I see](#) after clicking "Timeline" on the "Location Services" page

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2 more replies

**Practical-Custard-64** • 1y ago

Probably has something to do with this: <https://www.androidpolice.com/google-maps-timeline-bug/>

**srj737** OP • 1y ago

Cheers for highlighting

**scorp312** • 1y ago

This happened to me last week as well but coincidentally I was planning to upgrade my phone from a Pixel 7 Pro to a Pixel 9 Pro this past Friday. After setting up my 9 Pro I went into Google Maps and imported the 7 Pro backup and thankfully all of my timeline data was still there. Strangely my 7 Pro still seems to show all of its timeline data has been wiped, and I can't seem to restore the backup on that device.

The backup was 2 days old so I have 2 days last week with nothing, but that's not a huge deal compared to losing years of data.

Would have hated to lose this info. I've travelled to 33 countries and do like to regularly look back on places I've been. Hopefully a solution is found to restore others data.

**RuleSubverter** • 1y ago

This is what happens when Google lays people off and expects things to be normal running lean on staff. Fuck the shareholders; focus on the customers.

**Nevermind86** • 1y ago

Don't forget they botched hundreds of millions of their Chromecast devices just a few months ago as well. Might be related to them firing their US based engineers and re-hiring them in cheap Southeast Asian locations... The company is going downhill super fast. Even their basic product, Search, is almost useless these days.

**[deleted]** • 1y ago

Uh, what? You're not the customer, you're the product. Google doesn't sell phones, they sell ad space and ad targeting data.

**RuleSubverter** • 1y ago

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**pspr33** • 1y ago

Thanks for bringing this to my attention. My data is also gone.

I think I made a backup before but I can't be 100% sure as I don't have time to check right now. Huge bummer.

**srj737** OP • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

Just messaging in case it helps you: Following the emails from Google yesterday, they have changed something, and people are discovering their data is back.

If you have still lost a lot of data, I encourage you to try to IMPORT the Timeline Maps backup AGAIN *(even if you've tried before and it didn't work - it may work again now!)* You do this by doing: Phone's Maps App > Click on your face/profile icon > Your Timeline > Cloud Icon > 3 Dots > Import)
- You may need to try this from a second phone...

And if that works then 100% make sure that you *regularly* export 'un-encrypted' backups, just so you have control over your own data in case something like this happens again! (i.e. by doing: Phone's Settings > Location > Location Services > Timeline > Export timeline data) At least you will have your 'own' data and could view it in some other service!

[+ 2 more replies](#)**EzioAuditore1459** • 1y ago

Pixel 8

This makes me so sad. I loved reminiscing about my old vacations by following the path I took on timeline. I still have photos, but it feels like a piece of my memories was stolen.

**srj737** OP • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

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[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**j_sn_w** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro

Yup it's missing on mine too

But I have moved all my data away to davarich a few months ago and have my location data from home assistant store in it too. So I have a self hosted timeline system.

Annoying for those who haven't exported the data, but it seems more like a bug than the data actually being missing

[+ 2 more replies](#)**Jesucresta** • 1y ago

yes, gone. Google killing it lately, really forcing me to think about a Nothing phone or similar.

**bjoswald83** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

Wait for reviews. The 2 series had very bad display problems.

**srj737** **OP** • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

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[+ 1 more reply](#)**SillyLittleRaabit** • 1y ago

Timeline was one of the only things keeping me on a Google phone.... Hello, Apple...

[+ 2 more replies](#)**78wesley** • 1y ago

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**Chris4971** • 1y ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

Yup. Followed the instructions and still lost it. Very annoying.

[+ 2 more replies](#)**Sisiwakanamaru** • 1y ago

Pixel 7 Pro

Yup, I can confirm this

[+ 1 more reply](#)**LilacFitzpatrick** • 1y ago

This exact same thing just happened to me.

I have travel data from Friday from 4:56pm onward, but nothing before. Even though I know my phone was charged and on all day.

There is no data visible from the previous day or all the years before.

What. The. Fuck.

[+ 3 more replies](#)**12345-password** • 1y ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

All gone on my 7 pro

[+ 1 more reply](#)**notnobodyspecial** • 1y ago

I'm missing mine, but I think it's because my phone was stolen. I would have thought I'd have selected the back up option though :(

This sucks.

[+ 1 more reply](#)**yottabit42** • 1y ago

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service.

**srj737** OP • 1y ago

Unfortunately not, I trusted the "securely backed up" cloud in-built into Maps...

I never extracted Location History from Takeout before, and now Google Takeout just is a pathetic little 'Encrypted Backups.txt' text file that just says "*You have encrypted Timeline backups stored on Google servers.*"

I'd encourage anyone who still has their and is interested in at lease keeping it (regardless of it can never be loaded back into Google maps) to export the manual unencrypted timeline data:

Phone's Settings > Location > Location Services > Timeline > Export timeline data

**kevinbeard** • 1y ago

Something very odd is going on. I have two accounts on my phone. On the main account all history has gone before 8th March 2025. If I switch to my other account in Google Maps I can see my history going back many years.

However, if I go into location setting to export the data, even if I select the account that has all the history in maps, only data back to 8th Match 2025 is exported.

I'm worried how long the history will last on my older account!

**wytze2** • 1y ago

Yep, noticed it has been missing for 2 days and can't get anything done to retrieve it. Also I know for sure I don't have auto delete enabled, and storage was on device. Nearly 12 years of info gone, I really hope it will be restored somehow

[+ 2 more replies](#)**Jobya** • 1y ago

Same here, over a decade of data lost for me as well. Might have an old backup somewhere but can't remember.

[+ 2 more replies](#)**More-Competition-832** • 1y ago

Noticed on 03/07/2025 that years of my Timeline before 03/05/2025 "/" gone

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corrected by Google and have 2 Timelines to edit ???

[2 more replies](#)



Head_Banger88 • 1y ago

Yeah same here. What a bummer. Lost all the info of places I've been on in trips, which i really enjoyed looking back on. Hoping for a fix since I know my data was backed up but I can't access it now.



Head_Banger88 • 1y ago

I'm a little hopeful that this data can be restored. I see that Google photos can still tell me the location on maps of where I took those pictures and I see info of me accessing timeline in my maps history, so fingers crossed. This is pretty annoying though especially if it can't be restored

[1 more reply](#)



HaggisAreReal • 1y ago

This raises new concerns on the suitability of Google to protect my data and fulfil my right to ACCESS and PORTABILITY following GDPR Will I need to report this to a third party for loss of MY data by an update Google has botched?



Two-Clouds • 1y ago

Here's an interesting thought... One of the main changes to Google Timeline was that Google would start storing data on each of our local devices... Since they have deleted the data, does that mean that Google deleted data from our devices? That doesn't sound like a legal thing to do, what right do they have to delete data from our devices?



Itchy_Habit9508 • 1y ago

Since there's not much I can do right now, I'm going through all the Google Community forum posts that the OP shared and clicking 'I have the same question' on each one to help draw attention. Feel free to join in, everyone!

[1 more reply](#)



n_1diot • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

My data is back!

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file was only 1.5MB, but today after getting the email, I hit restore in Google maps app and it worked! Got my history back! So out of curiosity, I went into setting/location/location services/timeline and it showed heaps there, downloaded the file (export) and it was 13MB this time. Not sure how they did it, but glad to see it resolved for me!

Also to note, the Google maps app now has a restore option on the backup, last week that option didn't exist

 2 more replies**Rosielee11** • 1y ago

I had an e-mail from Google just over an hour ago! They acknowledged the issue and talked about a fix. This has now fixed the issue on my phone.

Previously where you had back ups enabled, you could select your current device, but had no option to import your data. Now you have the option to import to your current device, from your current device. Doing this has returned everything for me.

(Previously the fix above worked on another device, but not my mobile).

**Nevermind86** • 1y ago

WTF Google, first they botch hundreds of millions of Chromecast devices around the world for a week, and now they delete the Timeline data. Company going downhill fast. Even their most basic service, Search, sucks big time these days.

**Allisonsonc** • 1y ago

I received official communication from Google about this today in an email:

From: Google Maps Timeline • noreply-maps-timeline@google.com

Hi,

We briefly experienced a technical issue that caused the deletion of Timeline data for some people. Your account may have been impacted.

If you have encrypted backups enabled, you might be able to restore your data. Make sure you have the latest version of Google Maps, then go to your Timeline. Tap the cloud icon near the top of the screen and choose a backup to import your data.

If you didn't have backups turned on, unfortunately, the lost data cannot be recovered.

We understand that this can be frustrating if you use Timeline to remember places you've visited, and we are taking steps to improve our systems for the future.

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**JohnGypsy** 🍰 • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

Just got that also. I love how their suggestion is to go import a backup and then says if you didn't turn on backups, then it is gone. I, like many others, DID HAVE ON BACKUPS and it is STILL gone, of course -- because they only keep ONE backup and have already over-written it repeatedly since March 6th! By the time this email was sent by Google, NO ONE likely has any viable backup because it doesn't give you a choice of multiple dates like they imply! It just has the last backup -- which is usually within the last day or so. So I really hate the "if you didn't have backups on, then the data can't be recovered." Um, even if we HAVE backups on, it can't be recovered because you took over 14 days to even acknowledge this problem properly and the backups have all been over-written by you!

EDIT: My data is back! So, as others have now mentioned, even though the backup SAYS it was from just a day ago (when the data was already lost), something else is going on -- because I just restored "yesterday"'s backup -- and suddenly all my data from the past 10+ years is back! So, even if the backup looks more recent than makes sense for your last data, do the import anyhow.

On a side note, it is very interesting what is going on. Google is doing daily backups. So how does the most recent backup after this data loss have the data from before March 7th in it?? When it didn't when I tried to restore a backup around March 10th? This would imply that Google is actually keeping multiple days/weeks/months (?) of backups and then has now done something to merge them together? Even though we never have access to the older ones normally? I'm just very interested in the technical details now -- because some of this just doesn't make sense unless Google has a lot more backups than we are normally aware of.

**srj737** OP • 1y ago

Great news! Same for me here (importing backup option that never worked before, suddenly started working yesterday).

I will just make sure I take regular un-encrypted backups of the data manually in future!

[+ 3 more replies](#)**space_kat** • 1y ago

I lost it too 😞

[+ 1 more reply](#)**VanWesley** • 1y ago

Pixel 8 Pro

Damn. Just checked. Mine is gone too.

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**laxor09** • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

Oh no, I'm also affected. All data before March 8th is lost.

It's interesting that on the same day Health Connect sync also stopped working for me. Last data there is from March 7th.

— (+) 1 more reply

**i_wish_i_were_a_cat** • 1y ago

My timeline is also gone. There has been no fix that I am aware of right now. I am very upset

— (+) 2 more replies

**faffalaff** • 1y ago

Damn. Me too.

— (+) 2 more replies

**MacaroniNJesus** • 1y ago

Mine is gone. Pixel 8 and 4a. My mom still seems to have hers on pixel 3a. At least that's what it shows when I checked her history on her Chromebook

— (+) 6 more replies

**mabelanddot** • 1y ago

I use mine to keep track of job visits and such when I get too busy. Went back to verify and everything is gone from before March 7th. Devastating

**Rantakemisti** • 1y ago

The same here. I also diligently corrected my visits and tracked my office time on Google Maps. Now all is gone.

— (+) 1 more reply

**Terru03** • 1y ago

yeah mine is missing too

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Just messaging in case it helps you: Following the emails from Google yesterday, they have changed something, and people are discovering their data is back.

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- You may need to try this from a second phone...

And if that works then 100% make sure that you *regularly* export 'un-encrypted' backups, just so you have control over your own data in case something like this happens again! (i.e. by doing: [Phone's Settings > Location > Location Services > Timeline > Export timeline data](#)) At least you will have your 'own' data and could view it in some other service!

[+ 2 more replies](#)



CRXed • 1y ago

My Timeline is broken as well, but I already did the tranfer to Local months ago and I see this in my Android Settings, leading me to believe the data is there on my phone, just not in Maps.....

"3019 visits and routes saved to this device since 31 july 2014"



denverscooter7 • 1y ago

Where in the settings are you seeing "3019 visits and routes saved to this device since 31 july 2014"?

[+ 4 more replies](#)



Environmental-Wolf61 • 1y ago

My history is also lost, i hope they are going to restore it somehow.

[+ 1 more reply](#)



MsWonderWall • 1y ago

Lesson is look after your own data, especially if it is important.



PoopFandango • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

I have the exact same problem, found this while searching for a fix. ffs.



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something, and people are discovering their data is back.

If you have still lost a lot of data, I encourage you to try to IMPORT the Timeline Maps backup AGAIN (even if you've tried before and it didn't work - it may work again now!) You do this by doing: Phone's Maps App > Click on your face/profile icon > Your TImeline > Cloud Icon > 3 Dots > Import)
- You may need to try this from a second phone...

And if that works then 100% make sure that you *regularly* export 'un-encrypted' backups, just so you have control over your own data in case something like this happens again! (i.e. by doing: Phone's Settings > Location > Location Services > Timeline > Export timeline data) At least you will have your 'own' data and could view it in some other service!

1 more reply



OkExplorer290 • 1y ago

I've got the same issue and I've reached out to Google One Support. I've had a very frustrating chain of emails with them where they just keep asking me questions about my device and my app.

After being asked the same questions for a second time, I said "I already provided answers to these questions when you asked them 3 days ago. Can you please confirm if this is a known issue that is actually being looked in to?"

The response was:

"We highly appreciate you taking the time to contact us for your concern. Thank you for the followup. As per checking here in our end, it seems like there is a known issue with Google Maps and what I can do here is to check this with our backend team. Can you please confirm when was the last time that you were able to access the timeline as well as if you tried to use Google Takeout just to check if there will be data that can be detected in our end?"

My takeout that I did after spotting this issue came back very empty. So unfortunately I have now lost all hope of recovery 😞

4 more replies



nayyarsyed • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

As some of the users mentioned special thanks to -- user <https://www.reddit.com/user/saharaci/>

So far here is what i have found to ensure if your data is in your device or not and how to put it on the servers again or backup to the local device copy (Json format)

OPTION 1 - Can try

If you are lucky to have another phone lying around where you are signed in and using the google maps earlier

1, Goto maps

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4, if you can see the backuped files under your email address below Under heading - "your backups"

click on the three dots on them and press import and this may bring abck all your data on this device.. and confirm if you can see your timelines shows the decades of data if yes then you are good ..

OPTION 2 (if no 2nd phone) Try this

Dont got into maps

instead Click Settings --> Location --> Location services -->Timeline --> Select the account you used for keeping the timeline

it will open the another screen with timeline details and there you can see if your "View your timeline" option displays thousands of visits and routes saved on this device since MMM, dd, YYYY (it could read Feb , 12 , 2012) that means you are in business.

On same screen there is a menu you can click on Export Timeline Data to get the complete JSON (not need to go to Google take out) and this will dowload a huges JSON format file this can be either used by a power BI person to plot your dashboard or there are certains timeline viewers custom made (not sure about the privacy though and risky to use) best way is to employ someone who can do power BI report on GIS JSON data and bang... you are back on track with your own data ..

Cuation putting the backup file on cloud --> NOTE : ONLY CLICK ON BACKUP WHEN YOU SEE THAT ITS SHOWING YOUR DECADES OF DATA ELSE IT WILL WRITE THE BLANK COPY TO SERVER..

. If you want to back up click on the Back up and it will create a fresh backup file on the servers , this is the exact same file you see when you click on the maps application --> timeline --> small cloud on the right top and it shows you the backed up files.

I have successfully recovered the Json data and my timeline as well i got around 5 devices lying around with my name signed in so i imported them on all of them and download Json on 2 of them to stay local and will see if i can develop a power Bi report from this to use it at my own (experimental though)

All the best.



CRXed • 1y ago

I have discovered something weird.

I have 2 backups on Google's servers, 1 from January when I switched phones. The other is recent and probably having the *everything deleted* problem.

When I import that January backup to my new phone, I still don't get my complete history back, only some, a few months worth.

I looked up my old phone and imported that SAME backup there.....boom, ALL my timeline history back to 2014 is imported!! Everything is back!

Why does that make a difference??

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The JSON export on the old phone is now also much bigger. So at least I have everything on my old phone and in JSON format now....

Only difference at the moment is that the old phone does NOT have a cloud backup enabled. I am afraid to enable it right now, I don't want it to overwrite anything right now. Or will it show up in the cloud as a 3rd backup?

**nayyarsyed** • 1y ago

i did exactly same , and it gave me all my full history for last 15 years from an my current device backup which was from Jan 2025 and although lost every thing for last few months which i can live with when i am able to get 15 years back .. so here what i did

I have around 3-4 devices with my signup account i went to the cloud and check it was showing my old backup i.e. 5th Jan 25 so i was sure enough that its the same that hold my 15 years of data so i selected the backup and imported on all of my devices so i have now the history restored on all of my devices

and yesterday i found that i can export in Json format so i did that on atleast 2 of my old devices ...and relieve of sigh i dont care what in the future google will do i have lost my trust on it

what i am gonna do is as follows "

Use my exported Json on a power BI to display my 1.5 decade old

for now onwards will only use 3rd party tools open source to log my GPS routes or else i will write get it written by any junior dev to write a code for me to display my GPS logs and able to export them in Json so the future data can be tracked as well .

for me until Google give s a fool proof solution i will never gonna trust and will soon downloading all my Gmails , Photos , Gdrive etc and will have a local copy at home...!! NOPS to CLOUD FOR EVER now. My Data My device...

**D-Trick39** • 1y ago

TIMELINE DATA RESTORED!

Quite simply, I followed the instructions from that recent Google email from 3/21.

I selected the cloud icon and imported the data from the current device. It did say my last backup was yesterday which made me skeptical, but it worked. I had previously not done this due to fears of touching anything and losing data forever.

PHEW. My data goes back to 2013! I immediately exported the data to save my own copy in the cloud.



1 more reply

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to pull up the prior backups.

"We briefly experienced a technical issue that caused the deletion of Timeline data for some people. We're reaching out as your account may have been impacted. If you have encrypted backups enabled, you may be able to restore your data. Make sure you have the latest version of Google Maps, then go to your Timeline. Tap the cloud icon () near the top of your screen, and choose a backup to import your data. If you did not have backups turned on, unfortunately you will not be able to recover lost data. We understand that this can be frustrating if you use Timeline to remember places you've visited, and we are taking steps to improve our systems for the future. The Timeline Team"



Loose-Copy5852 • 1y ago

Can confirm, just got an email an hour ago 4:40pm cst



stevied71 • 1y ago

I only just found out about this via an email from Google. I've lost the lot.



Illustrious-Engine23 • 1y ago

I'm beyond pissed at this, I lost all my data from 10+ years ago.

I'm sure I specifically enables back up to phone when they changed to device only timeline data.

It was already a terrible idea not to keep this data on the cloud and they managed to fuck it up further. I lost a lot of trust in google's ability to store my data.



Jumpy-Tap-1022 • 1y ago

Is Timeline updating for anyone who successfully restored from their backup?

Mine is frozen despite me checking the settings, clearing the cache & doing a full reboot of the phone.

Seems like the incident is not fully over yet.



Adessoadesso • 1y ago

Exactly the same here, stopped updating at the precise moment I restored the backup. I can't even add visits manually to the timeline.



[2 more replies](#)



Jumpy-Tap-1022 • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

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that cache & data initially, which caused me a scare as it sent me back to where we were last week & wouldn't restore the location data at first. Once that was ruled out as the culprit I looked at a few other background services:

- Fused Location
- Service Provider Location
- SLocation (I have a Samsung phone so this may be named differently for others)

I cleared the cache for all 3, restarted my phone & everything immediately worked 🙏 I'd previously tried clearing Fused Location so my money is on SLocation being the culprit.

The restart after the cache Clear is VERY important.

3 more replies



GoombaAdventurer • 1y ago

Pixel 6

Same here 🙏



srj737 OP • 1y ago

Just messaging in case it helps you: Following the emails from Google yesterday, they have changed something, and people are discovering their data is back.

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1 more reply



ocellariz • 1y ago

Samen here, backup was on, never delete.... years of data lost 😡

1 more reply



[deleted] • 1y ago

yep, same her

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**pqtme** • 1y ago

Mine is missing everything from many years ago until last year when I upgraded from 8 Pro to 9 Pro.

**dramake** • 1y ago

Pixel 8

My partner also noticed this. He's having results only from 3/4 days ago and forward. Nothing before that.

Personally I haven't been affected.

**srj737** OP • 1y ago

Yep, sounds to be exactly the same... Something definitely happened approx 6th 7th March that f'd up many users data...

Thanks for responding! If I ever get a resolution, I'll message you.

I've currently got [a response on the forums](#) that they are aware of this and it "may be transient" and fixed in a couple of days, but I don't have a lot of hope...

[+ 1 more reply](#)**Ryano891** • 1y ago

Yep, same here. Mine is gone

**srj737** OP • 1y ago

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 [3 more replies](#)**charlotte6789** • 1y ago

+1 here, Pixel 8a, 5 years of travel history lost :/ Me, this morning, when realised it:
<https://tenor.com/view/lost-gif-738426745720007006>

[1 more reply](#)**Good_Cost_1912** • 1y ago

Yes, happened to me as well March 7th, all history prior to this is gone. Can't download backup to the original phone, option isn't there. Maybe on another phone? logout?

**srj737** **OP** • 1y ago

None, that I am aware of unfortunately. Logging in fresh on a new phone almost certainly doesn't work (I'd still try though). If you have any devices already logged and synced long ago, check them, but I think most people have it lost.

Unfortunately, unless you took a manual export of the unencrypted data before last weekend, then it seems Google has just deleted our successful backups from the cloud...

So the literal only solution will be Google seeing this hubbub, and choosing to restore all those deleted 6th March backups (/reconsolidate them into our Maps Timeline cloud backups), which given I don't believe they have even acknowledged it so far, then It feels unlikely...

[1 more reply](#)**Huge-Acanthaceae5350** • 1y ago

Mine story is completely the same, Using S23U. Last Friday - lost everything....

[1 more reply](#)**kividk** • 1y ago

All of my data from before March 7 has also been deleted. Has anyone found any reasonable (preferably self-hosted) alternatives for moving forward?

[2 more replies](#)

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answer. That's a real bummer, I guess I'm not the only one but my Timeline was *REALLY* special to me. I've been using this function consistently since 2019, and the reason it is special is because I love repeatedly reviewing special days in my life, such as the day me and my current girlfriend had our first date.

Hopefully they'll fix this sooner rather than later, but at least from this I've learned to always have some sort of backup for special things like this.



1 more reply

**Upset_Personality422** • 1y ago

Same here, Pixel 9. Also did all requested actions to preserve data. Anything from 6th March 2025 and older vanished. Also tried to download data from my Google account, the timeline is clean..



1 more reply

**Consistent_Day_4653** • 1y ago

Same for me, no option to import back up. Opened chat with Google, but after being instructed to do what I had already done, was told that

" For now, we just need to wait for our product Engineers to work out thhis issue."



2 more replies

**trdr88** • 1y ago

Pixel 8 Pro

Me too

**rawrglesnaps** • 1y ago

I'm in the same boat, I tried to load the backup but it only recovered a few random weeks of a couple years. Not sure why it was only that, and strange to me why those weeks only. Hoping to see something from Google but at this point it's probably not going to be good news.

**santz007** • 1y ago

Shit, just checked, all history gone before march 8th 2025 despite me making sure all settings were correctly configured to prevent auto delete many months ago



2 more replies

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#) [+ 1 more reply](#)**Micheliumed** • 1y ago

I lost mine too, been going since 2016, showing all the places on travelling I did on the world map. And now it just goes back to 7th of March 2025. Really upsetting. First they make it already vulnerable, by removing it from desktops and now this.. fuck that.

 [+ 2 more replies](#)**kumaezenjae** • 1y ago

Has anyone tried accessing timeline data from a phone backup made after the transition to on-device storage but before the recent bug which invalidated the cloud backups? I haven't had a chance to try this solution yet, my backup is a few months old but my timeline data spanned over a decade.

 [+ 2 more replies](#)**nouchie98** • 1y ago

Yes my data also gone on 7th of March. I made a backup just now and it's 2.92 mb so I think I recovered all the data in the .json file. Let's hope they fix it

 [+ 2 more replies](#)**Engedoras** • 1y ago

Same problem as everyone else who manually migrated their timeline data to their device after the email from Google. Google fucked up big with this one... I tried the method of logging in with an old account that I removed a couple years ago. I suspect that here the timeline history was still stored on the Google servers (not just on the device), so I was able to restore the data from 2020-21, but not after. When I tried to create a completely new account to maybe somehow import recent data from my phone, the option to activate timeline history at all was disabled. So it looks like they completely screwed up this feature with the last update by disabling it completely, which gives me some hope that they're working on it. I'm still not sure if they're bothering to restore the data, a displaying error would be the best, but an unlikely scenario.

 [+ 1 more reply](#)**Unhappy-Being-2972** • 1y ago

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2 more replies

**OIXondof** • 1y ago

Just found this, absolutely fuming... Google Maps app still apparently has 1.36GB of data, so it could be in there? But clearing cache and every other workaround has done nothing, I have nothing before March 7th. I think my data went back to 2012...

3 more replies

**Junior_Length_279** • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

So, I experienced this same problem as everyone else, but managed to re import my 14 years of data through the import option on my backup.. However, at that point, it stopped recording anything new on my Timeline, so I started inputting visits myself (just until it's sorted!!!)...

Today, I came back to check all my old data was still there (as I do every day), and lo and behold, I find it has started recording my Timeline again from today... but **everything prior to 14 February** has disappeared again...

I am set to no auto-delete, so how has it auto-deleted!!!? Jeez, Google. Sort it!!!

So now I need to re import my backup (which is showing last saved a week ago so hopefully should still have everything in it) but I can't because I have no import option any more.

What to do, what to do...!

I can;t believe it's done this AGAIN.

*** UPDATE LATER THE SAME DAY ***

So, I got an old phone out and imported my usual phone's backup into its Timeline. It turns out the backup doesn't have my whole timeline, it has everything since 14 February... why 14 February??? This makes no sense. Where's the rest gone? This would indicate that Backup simply isn't backing everything up. I am now thinking I should switch on backup on my tablet where currently everything up to 7 March resides. Then try to import the backup it creates into my phone....

But what if the tablet goes the same way as my phone did, and switching on backup causes it to lose everything until the last month.

I wish Google would start advising, this is awful.

**matheod** • 1y ago

Still isnt fixes :(



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